

Making Decisions

Branching on what the user told us

IF / ELSE

Following a different path

```
if (age >= 18) {  
    std::println("You are an adult.");  
} else {  
    std::println("You are a minor.");  
}
```

We have one condition and two possible outcomes.

TWO VARIABLES

Comparisons between two variables

```
if (age == friendAge) {  
    std::println("{} and {} are the same age.", name, friendName);  
} else if (age < friendAge) {  
    std::println("{} is younger than {}.", name, friendName);  
} else {  
    std::println("{} is older than {}.", name, friendName);  
}
```

3.5 / THE OPERATORS

The comparison operators used here

OPERATOR	MEANING
<code>==</code>	equal to
<code><</code>	less than
<code>>=</code>	greater than or equal to

A GOTCHA

Leftover newline

```
std::cin >> age;  
std::cin.ignore(); // discard the leftover newline  
  
std::getline(std::cin, friendName); // otherwise this reads an empty line
```

`std::cin >>` leaves the `\n` you pressed sitting in the input buffer - the very next `getline` reads that leftover newline as an empty line if you don't clear it first.

3.5 / CONDITIONAL BREAKPOINTS

Only stop when it matters

Right-click a breakpoint on the `if` line and add a **condition**, e.g.
`age < 18` - the debugger only pauses when that's true, instead of every single run.